

Date	2024-02-01	Time	14:00–16:30
Location	Conference room C2, Villeurbanne site	Ref.	CRI-PROD-2024-007
Chair	Mr Bertrand Vidal, Production Manager	Secretary	Ms Laurence Aubert, Industrial Management Assistant

ATTENDEES

Name	Role / Department	Attendance
Mr Bertrand Vidal	Production	Present
Mr Jean-Paul Moreau	Maintenance	Present
Ms Ingrid Hoffmann	QHSE	Present
Mr Samuel Osei	Logistics / Shipping	Present
Ms Carole Petit	Purchasing	Present
Mr Thierry Bruneau	Management control	Present
Ms Laurence Aubert	Secretariat / Admin	Present

AGENDA

- January 2024 production KPIs — variance analysis
- Incidents and near misses for the month
- Status of preventive and corrective maintenance
- Raw material supply — pressure on MEG
- Preparation for the external ISO 9001 audit (March 2024)
- Any other business

PROCEEDINGS

1. Production KPIs — January 2024

Mr Vidal presented the production dashboard: overall utilisation rate 78.3% (target 85%), down against December 2023 (82.1%). Main factors: the unplanned shutdown of reactor R-201 (24-26 January, 2.5 days), and reduced throughput in the solvents workshop linked to the MEG supply pressure (item 4).

Output achieved: 847 tonnes (target 920 t, variance -8.0%). By workshop: solvents 312 t (target 350 t), acids 203 t (target 210 t), bases 180 t (target 185 t), specialities 152 t (target 175 t).

First pass yield (FPY): 94.1% (target 97%). Batches rejected: 3 batches (solvent A-45 batch B241089, hydrochloric acid batch B241102, glycerol batch B241134). Causes: out-of-specification purity deviation for the first two, trace Al contamination for the glycerol (raw material origin suspected — see action).

Mr Bruneau (management control): average unit production cost €1.42/kg against a budget of €1.38/kg, +2.9%. The variance is mainly linked to energy costs (+8.4% vs budget, a market trend). Raw material costs are within budget. Action: assess the opportunity of a fixed-price energy contract for 2025.

2. Incidents and near misses

Ms Hoffmann (QHSE) presented the safety summary: 0 lost-time accidents in January. 2 near misses recorded: (PA-2024-003) minor leak on valve V-218 during a gasket replacement — detected during a control round, no spillage, maintenance intervention within 25 min. (PA-2024-004) a fall from height was avoided: an operator without a harness on walkway P-07, immediate procedure reminder issued.

Following PA-2024-003: an audit of all valves in the solvents workshop, prioritising valves more than 3 years old. Scheduled by Mr Moreau (maintenance) for March-April 2024. Estimated budget: €22k.

Following PA-2024-004: a reminder of the working-at-height procedure was posted in all workshops. The mandatory harness training for new starters was reviewed — a practical assessment was added on top of the existing theory module. Ms Hoffmann is leading this.

Cumulative YTD safety indicators: LTIFR (lost time) = 0 ; TRIFR (no lost time) = 62.5 ; severity rate = 0.

3. Maintenance

Mr Moreau presented the maintenance status: 94% of the preventive plan completed in January (46/49 jobs). 3 deferrals: heat exchanger E-105 (part on order), pump P-312 (specialist intervention scheduled 10 Feb), agitator A-201 (reactor R-201 shutdown — see below).

R-201 shutdown (24-26 Jan): failure of the mechanical seal on agitator A-201. A spare part was available in stock but the intervention required a full purge of the reactor. Total downtime: 60h. Recommendation: increase the stock of mechanical seals for critical reactors (2 units minimum per reactor). Mr Moreau will propose an update to the critical spare parts plan.

OEE (Overall Equipment Effectiveness) for January: 71.2% (target 80%). Availability: 84%, Performance: 88%, Quality: 96%. The main area for improvement is availability (unplanned shutdowns).

4. Supply — Pressure on monoethylene glycol (MEG)

Ms Petit (Purchasing) reported worldwide pressure on MEG since mid-January: a production cut at SABIC (Saudi Arabia) following maintenance on a cracker unit, and strong Asian demand (PET textiles). Spot price: +18% in 3 weeks. Current ChemCorp stock: 45 tonnes (12 days of cover).

Emergency actions: (1) A spot order of 30 t from Brenntag (delivery 8 Feb, spot price + 12%). (2) Contact with supplier BASF to bring forward the February contract delivery (+15 t). (3) Rationalisation of formulations: a review is under way with R&D on partially substituting DEG for MEG in non-critical formulations (5 products identified).

Mr Vidal proposed launching a study into building a 90-day strategic stock for the 5 most critical raw materials. Mr Bruneau will cost the corresponding working capital (preliminary estimate: €800k–€1.2M).

Minutes CRI-PROD-2024-007 — Action plan

ACTION PLAN

Owner	Action to be taken	Due date
Mr Moreau	Audit solvents workshop valves over 3 years old + replacement budget proposal	2024-03-15
Ms Hoffmann	Revise the working-at-height training module (add practical assessment)	2024-02-28
Ms Petit	Finalise the 30 t MEG spot order with Brenntag	2024-02-02
Mr Bruneau	Cost the working capital for a 90-day strategic stock of 5 critical raw materials	2024-02-15
Mr Vidal	Propose an update to the critical reactor spare parts plan	2024-02-15
Quality Lab (Mr Lecomte)	Identify the source of Al contamination in glycerol batch B241134	2024-02-09

Next meeting: 7 March 2024, 14:00, Room C2

These minutes will be deemed approved unless written comments are received within 5 working days of circulation.